Strategy on a page

The aim: run KOR **like a Fortune 500 company** in BD, financials, operations and IT, on tools built for it (Part 4). This page: where KOR should play, how it wins, and what Operations must fix. **Every choice is a recommendation** for you and the partners; every number comes from KOR's own record.

WHERE WE STAND

Four numbers that set the agenda

$367k / month
invoiced Apr–Sep 2026, down from $490k Oct–Mar. The firm is billing a quarter less.

43%
of submitted proposals won since 2020. 72% of decided ones, but 266 were never closed out.

$1.41M
owed over 90 days, of $2.26M. Each 30 days off DSO frees about $423k.

0 of 110
live pursuits carry a fee estimate, so the pipeline has no dollar value yet.

Read together: **less work is coming in, what is won is slow to turn into cash, and the pipeline cannot yet say what is coming next.** Jim and JM expect a quiet market until January and then a rush. The plan below uses the quiet months to fix the process, so the rush lands on a working system.

YOURS, NOT THE SYSTEM'S

What you and the partners decide

- **The goals and their numbers.** The figures above are starting points from KOR's record, not commitments.
- **Which repeat developers each partner owns,** and who qualifies the low-converting clients.
- **The $805k on inactive projects.** 31103-01 alone is $502k, last invoiced February 2024.
- **Whether the US gets more than Jim's time.** It holds 17 of the 110 live pursuits and one person sells it.

HOW SURE EACH NUMBER IS

Win rates come from the 701-pursuit fee tracker, 2020–2026. "Never closed" means no Deltek job appeared within 180 days; that test found a job for 249 of 266 known wins and for 6 of 478 known losses. Sector win rates are left out because lost proposals carry no reliable sector. Money figures are the Financials engine's, read by this morning's brief.

Sources: docs/KOR-Management-Win-Loss-2026-10-18.md (tracker win/loss, clients, regions, fee bands, loss reasons); the morning brief of 19 October 2026 (Financials engine: AR, aging, over budget, utilization, invoiced and collected by month, DSO; live pursuits from the CRM); docs/KOR-Impact-Scoreboard-2026-10-18 (targets); the 9 October BD meeting (market read and cadence).

RECOMMENDATION · YOU DECIDE

Strategy

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Win more of the right work, earlier

WHERE TO PLAY

- **Grow the developers who already choose KOR.** Westland, Northland, Cressey, Domus, Kerkhoff and Polygon: 40 won, 1 lost.
  Each gets a named partner and a standing check-in, not a proposal-by-proposal relationship.
- **Metro Vancouver and South of Fraser are the base.** 220 of 281 wins since 2020; South of Fraser converts 81% of decided proposals.
- **The US is the growth market.** 22 wins at 65% decided, and 17 of 110 live pursuits, all Jim's.
- **Qualify hard before writing a fee for the clients who rarely convert.** NSDA, Wesgroup, Strand, Starlight and Porte: 12 won, 15 lost, 35 never decided.
  A go/no-go before the proposal, not after.

HOW KOR WINS

- **Get in as the architect's engineer before the RFP.** The structural engineer is usually chosen at the start of schematic design.
- **Mid-size fees convert best.** $25–100k wins 80% of decided; $250k and up wins 58%. Big bids are deliberate bets.
- **Close every proposal.** Follow up at 14 days, chase the decision at 45, and record who won and why. Glotman Simpson is the competitor named most often (6 of the stated losses).
- **Spread the selling.** One principal leads 345 of 701 pursuits (49%). Six owners now hold the 110 live pursuits.

GOALS TO 31 MARCH 2027 · NUMBERS YOURS TO SET

- Every live pursuit has a fee estimate and an owner's next step (today 0 of 110 have a fee).
- No proposal sits "submitted" past 60 days without an outcome.
- Submitted-to-won from 43% toward 50%.
- Invoicing back above $400k a month.

OPERATIONS

Turn work into cash, and stop giving hours away

WHERE IT HURTS

- **Cash.** $2.26M owed, $1.41M of it over 90 days, and $805k on projects no longer on the active list.
- **Overruns.** 272 of 814 active projects are over their hours budget; 72 are critical; 94 are burning hours faster than they bill.
- **Capacity.** Utilization is 70.8%.

PRIORITIES

- **Collect.** A partner owns every invoice over 90 days and reports at the quickie. Decide the $805k on inactive projects: collect, settle or write off.
- **Charge for changes before the hours are spent.** Extra-service letters on the worst ten over-budget projects first.
- **Bill on time.** Close the gap on the 94 projects where billing lags the hours.
- **Fix the process before January.** The rush should land on a working cadence, not a backlog.

GOALS TO 31 MARCH 2027 · FROM THE SCOREBOARD

- DSO from 174 to 120 days: about **$760k of cash** without billing a dollar more.
- Owed over 90 days under $700k.
- The $805k inactive AR decided, with the reason recorded.
- Over-budget projects down from 272, the worst ten with change orders.

THE REST OF THE PLAN

Parts 2 to 4

- **Part 2, the whole process on one page:** signal, pursuit, proposal, win, delivery, invoice, cash, with each stage's owner, its measure, and the part of the system that serves it.
- **Part 3, the rhythm:** the daily hour, the weekly roll-ups and the monthly meetings, each tied to a goal above, so every task traces back to this page.
- **Part 4, the platform:** the BD apps, Financials, Operations and IT tools that watch, prepare and draft, so a firm of sixty works like a Fortune 500 company.